



Five software to simplify your work environment

Managing a SOHO on your own can be quite taxing so here are a few software that can lessen the burden and optimise your work environment

Mithun Mohandas
readersletters@tbinkdigit.com

When it comes to a SOHO you are pretty much on your own. One does not have the luxury of hiring someone to take note of each and every aspect down to the smallest details. This is where software like the ones we've mentioned below come into the picture and make your work process a lot simpler and streamlined. So much that you can pretty much run a one man show with the efficiency of a multinational (Maybe that was a tad too exaggerated but you get the picture). These tools may not be better than your "system" but for those who don't have a system in place, this sure is a great place to start. Instead of focusing on separate tools we'll be looking at categories of software for simplifying your work environment.

Project Management Tool

A project management tool helps you organise your resources together and allocate them in an efficient manner. After completing a few projects one can

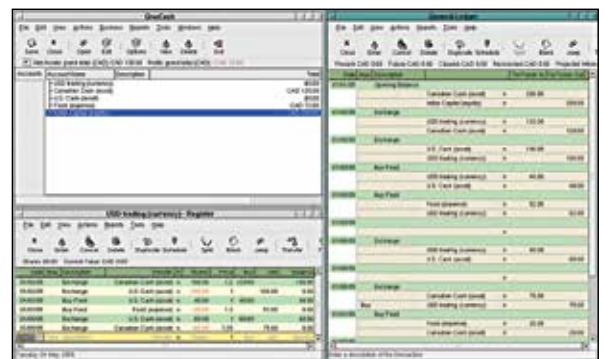
estimate the cost and time parameters of each task and thus figure out a pattern of completing tasks simultaneously rather than in a linear fashion. With the usual set of features like remote access and collaboration access the complexity of planning a project is greatly reduced and becomes more streamlined. Another aspect introduced is that of accountability since each and every action to be performed is recorded, it becomes easier to accurately pinpoint where delay/loss tend to occur and thus, allocate more resources to better handle that particular task.

The functionality of a CRM overlaps with that of a project management software because a CRM is basically a project management software where the "projects" are your customers. Ideally you should make do with just one software as it adds familiarity and subsequently your employees don't spend all their time fiddling around with 10-15 software instead of getting some actual work done.

A popular project management tool is Basecamp (<https://basecamp.com/>) is one such software that follows a monthly subscription approach with the cheapest plan costing \$20/month. One can opt for Canonical's Launchpad or Edgewall's Trac which are open source and quite popular. Although most of these software are geared towards managing software projects, you can

easily find one which caters to a much general approach.

An enterprise solution like Vtiger CRM actually has both project management and CRM modules which are interlinked. Interoperability is one more facet which justifies the use of one software for getting everything done.



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Accounting software

Face it, you can't code, manage all your employees and take care of the finances all by yourself without some help. Also, there are an incessant number of things you need to keep in mind when dealing with anything money related. One little goof-up and you'll have the taxman at your door for an audit. So you can either hire a team of five-six accountants or you could simply get one or two accountants and use an accounting software. The folks behind these software keep an eye out for changes in taxation and other rules. So instead of having to go through years of account books for any reason whatsoever, you can simply opt for the latest update for your accounting software and all your accounting standards (tax rules and all) will be updated according to the new standards. You don't have to send your accountants out for an expensive



ActivTrak's report web interface.